

Aluminium Cladding Layout Checklist

A facade checklist for reviewing grid, panel rhythm, joints, fixing logic, edges, openings, and material optimization before installation.

CHECKLIST | Execution Details | 7 pages | February 2026

Why Layout Review Prevents Waste

Aluminium cladding is cut to a grid, and the grid is set once. A layout decided without review is where waste is born: cut-offs above 25%, joints that land on window frames, and material shortages discovered mid-installation when re-ordering means weeks of delay.

Reviewing the layout on paper — module width, reference line, panel rhythm, and opening coordination — converts those risks into a half-day check. This checklist walks the facade from grid to termination so the rhythm is resolved before the first panel is fixed.

Use this checklist when

- The facade grid and module width are first set.
- Window and door positions are confirmed.
- Before releasing panels to cutting or order.

Section 1: Grid & Panel Rhythm

Item	Pass ✓	Fail ✗	Notes
Panel module width confirmed against the architectural grid.			
Starting reference line established (from grid axis or structural face).			
Panel rhythm consistent across the full facade elevation.			
Shadow-gap width uniform (typically 10–20 mm).			
Corner panels allow for the fixing return.			
Horizontal joint lines align across adjacent elevations.			
Vertical joints plumb and continuous where intended.			
Module accounts for structural and setting-out tolerance.			
Setting-out avoids slivers (panels narrower than half a module).			
Grid agreed with the architect before release.			

Section 2: Window & Door Coordination

Item	Pass ✓	Fail ✕	Notes
Panel joints do not bisect window frames.			
Window surround / reveal detail shown.			
Sill flashing below windows specified.			
Head flashing above windows specified.			
Jamb closure at window sides detailed.			
Opening dimensions match the architectural schedule.			
Panel cuts around openings minimize waste.			
Reveal depth consistent around each opening.			

Section 3: Fixing System Check

Item	Pass ✓	Fail ✗	Notes
Hidden-fix vs exposed-fix confirmed for each zone.			
Fixing rail spacing matches the panel span.			
Thermal break present between rail and structure.			
Wind-load design for the fixing verified by engineer.			
Bracket adjustment range covers structural tolerance.			
Fastener material compatible with aluminium (no bimetallic corrosion).			
Fixing allows for panel thermal movement.			
Maintenance / panel-replacement access considered.			

Section 4: Edge & Termination Details

Item	Pass ✓	Fail ✕	Notes
Top-of-cladding termination (below parapet or at soffit) detailed.			
Base of cladding minimum 150 mm above finished floor / grade.			
Corner details (internal and external) drawn.			
Expansion-joint positions shown at maximum 6 m horizontal.			
Movement joints align with structural movement joints.			
Edge trims and end caps specified.			
Weep / drainage path at base of cavity provided.			

Sign-off & Notes

Material optimization reminders

- Nest panel cuts from full sheets before ordering.
- Set the module so openings fall on joint lines, not mid-panel.
- Order a 5-8% panel overage for cuts and damage, not more.

Project Name	
Elevation / Zone	
Date	
Reviewed by	
Role	
Signature	

For facade engineering and fixing design support, contact SIPANEL: info@sipanelco.com